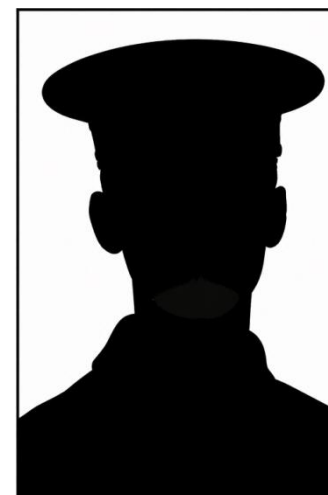




John Humphrey Stillman

1894 - 1918

Civilian Story

Field Name	Field Data	Source of data
Casualty Name	H Stillman	School plaque The link in the spreadsheet takes you to J H Stillman but it also mentions John Lyon School which none of the H Stillmans on the CWGC do, so I'm going with this suggestion
Date of Birth	22/10/1894 Paddington The BMD index records his middle name as Humphreys	School Admission Register (Ancestry) and De Ruvigny's Roll of Honour, 1914-1919 1911 census
Date of Death (from Spreadsheet)	30/9/1918	CWGC
Age at death (from Spreadsheet)	23	CWGC

Marital Status	States unmarried in the De Ruvigny's Roll of Honour (see below)	
Children (if any)		
Occupation prior to Call up	Bank Clerk (member of the Bankers Institute) 1911 – age 16, a Boy Clerk in the Civil Service	De Ruvigny's Roll of Honour, 1914-1919 (Ancestry) see below 1911 census
Parents	Son of Frank and Annie Ellen Stillman (nee Hillier), of 3, Lampton Villas, Tiverton Rd., Hounslow	CWGC & GRO births
Listed Address(s)	Same as above in 1911 16 The Parade, High Road Wealdstone 136 Portnall Rd, Paddington	1911 census 1901 census 1899 School Admission Register (Ancestry)
Parents /Fathers occupation	Carpenter Manager of a refreshment room	1911 census 1901 census
Brothers and Sisters	Dorothy May Ruth Stillman (younger)	1911 census
Years at John Lyon School		
University (if any)	Admitted to Moberley School, 9/9/1899 Educated at John Lyon's School, Harrow; Matriculated London University, at age of 16; member of Bankers' Institute.	School Admission Register (Ancestry) CWGC CWGC, See below CWGC
Obituary	See below	
Additional sources of data		
War Memorials:	John Lyon School, plaque, as H Stillman	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/341002
	John Lyon School, sundial, as H Stillman	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/341328
	Heston Memorial, as J H Stillman	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/memorial/1944
	St Leonard's Church, Heston	https://memorials.iwm.org.uk/name/1791141
	De Ruvigny's Roll of Honour, 1914-1919	Ancestry

Military Research

JLS WWI RoH	STILLMAN J.H.
CWGC Reference	https://www.cwgc.org/find-war-dead/casualty/4027342/stillman,-john-humphrey/
Age	23
DoD	30-Sep-18
Rank	Pte
Regiment	North Staffordshire Regiment 12th Bn
Location	TERLINCTHUN BRITISH CEMETERY, WIMILLE France
Military details	Son of Frank and Annie Ellen Stillman, of 3, Lampton Villas, Tiverton Rd., Hounslow, Middlesex; Educated at John Lyon's School, Harrow; Matriculated London University, at age of 16; member of Bankers' Institute. Private John Humphrey Stillman (Service Number 44682) died on September 30, 1918, at the age of 23. He served with the 12th Battalion of the Prince of Wales's (North Staffordshire Regiment), which fought within the 119th Brigade of the 40th Division. (Note: Prior to his service with the North Staffordshire Regiment, he served as Private 265788 in the Suffolk Regiment). Private Stillman is buried at the Thillo Road Cemetery in Beaulencourt, France (Grave Reference: Plot I, Row C, Grave 14). The cemetery is located roughly 3 kilometers southeast of Bapaume, in the Pas-de-Calais region of northern France. He died of wounds sustained during the final Allied push of the Hundred Days Offensive. By late September 1918, the German army was retreating across northern France under relentless Allied pressure. The 12th North Staffords were heavily engaged in the rapid advance, driving the enemy back through devastated terrain and former battlefields. During the fighting or tactical advances in late September, Private Stillman was severely wounded by enemy artillery shelling or machine-gun fire. He was successfully evacuated from the immediate firing line to a field ambulance or one of the active medical installations operating nearby. The Thillo Road Cemetery was specifically started in mid-September 1918 by the 53rd Field Ambulance and utilized by the 3rd, 4th, and 43rd Casualty Clearing Stations to bury soldiers who succumbed to their battlefield injuries. Stillman died at one of these medical units, just weeks before the Armistice

Story of Sacrifice

John Humphrey Stillman (1894–1918)

John Humphrey Stillman was a gifted scholar, committed Baptist and active church worker who attended the Lower School of John Lyon and later became a bank clerk. He served with the Suffolk and North Staffordshire Regiments during the First World War, dying in the closing weeks of the war, aged 23 in September 1918 succumbing to wounds received in action.

Civilian Life

John Humphrey Stillman was born in Paddington on 22 October 1894, the only son of Frank and Annie Ellen Stillman. The family later lived in Hounslow, from where John attended the Lower School of John Lyon, Harrow. He was academically gifted, matriculating for the University of London at the age of 16, and subsequently worked as a bank clerk and became a member of the Bankers' Institute. Religion was an important part of Stillman's civilian life. He was brought up in a Christian home and became closely involved with the Town Baptist Church. He was baptised there on 28 April 1912, aged 17, and served as a leader in the junior Sunday School, secretary of the Christian Band and a Seat Steward. In memorandum, The Rev. Frank Batten later described him as a "humble Christian and a gifted church worker. From his earliest years he took a deep interest in religious matters and as a school boy he was nick-named 'John-three-sixteen.'

Military Life

Stillman enlisted in the Suffolk Regiment in October 1915 and subsequently served with the North Staffordshire Regiment. His service record identifies him as Lance-Corporal John Humphrey Stillman, No. 44682, of the 12th (Service) Battalion, Prince of Wales's (North Staffordshire Regiment). He served in France and Flanders and was transferred to the North Staffordshire Regiment shortly before his death.

He died of wounds sustained during the final Allied push of the Hundred Days Offensive. By late September 1918, the German army was retreating across northern France under relentless Allied pressure. The 12th North Staffords were heavily engaged in the rapid advance, driving the enemy back through devastated terrain and former battlefields. During the fighting or tactical advances in late September, Stillman was severely wounded by enemy artillery shelling or machine-gun fire. He was successfully evacuated from the immediate firing line to a field ambulance or one of the active medical installations operating nearby. The Thillooy Road Cemetery was specifically started in mid-September 1918 by the 53rd Field Ambulance and utilized by the 3rd, 4th, and 43rd Casualty Clearing Stations to bury soldiers who succumbed to their battlefield injuries. Stillman died at one of these medical units on 30 September 1918, aged 23, just weeks before the Armistice. He is buried at the Thillooy Road Cemetery, Beaulencourt in the Pas-de-Calais region of France.

A contemporary Middlesex Chronicle report similarly recorded that he died in hospital in France from wounds received in action. His death was marked by his church as well as by his family. Preaching at the Town Baptist Church on Sunday evening, the Rev. Frank Batten said: "I cannot allow

this occasion to pass without referring to the loss this church has received through the translation of our fellow member Lance Corporal John. Humphrey Stillman. He died of wounds received in action before his parents could reach his bedside last Monday at the hospital in France. He was trained in a Christian home, and that training was the foundation of his life. From his earliest years he took a deep interest in religious matters and as a school boy he was nick-named 'John-three-sixteen.'" His parents subsequently expressed their thanks to friends who had written to them with sympathy and condolence following the loss of their only son.

Footnote: Some records show Stillman holding the rank of Private, others as Lance Corporal. This may illustrate that he had been selected for promotion just before he was wounded.

Notes

Middlesex Chronicle 12/10/1918	
DIED OF WOUNDS. FILLINGHAM: On 28th September, 1918, of wounds received in action in France, Major R. J. Fillingham, M.C., Royal Garrison Artillery, aged 28 years; only son of Sergeant-Major and Mrs. J. J. Fillingham, of Hounslow, and dearly beloved husband of youngest daughter of Sergeant-Major and Mrs. S. H. Wiebkin, of Norwood. STILLMAN: On September 30th, 1918, in hospital in France, from wounds received in action, Sept. 12th, L.-Cpl. John Humphrey Stillman, North Staffs. Regiment, in his 24th year, the only son of Mr. and Mrs. F. Stillman, Tiverton Road, Hounslow. IN MEMORIAM	STILLMAN: On September 30th, 1918, in hospital in France, from wounds received in action, Sept. 12th, L.-Cpl. John Humphrey Stillman, North Staffs. Regiment, in his 24th year, the only son of Mr. And Mrs. F. Stillman, Tiverton Road, Hounslow.

Middlesex Chronicle 12/10/1918

RETURN THANKS.

STILLMAN: Mr. and Mrs. F. Stillman and family wish to thank all those friends who have sent letters of sympathy and condolence to them in the loss of their only son, J. H. Stillman.

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cheerful and making satisfactory progress.

LANCE-CORPORAL J. H. STILLMAN.

Mr. and Mrs. Stillman, of 3, Lampton Villas, Tiverton-road, Hounslow, are mourning the loss of their son, Lance-Corporal John Humphrey Stillman, of the North Staffordshire Regiment, who died of gunshot wounds received in action, on September 29th in a hospital at Wimereux in France. This warrior, who served for many years in different capacities at the Town Baptist Church, answered the call in October, 1915, when he joined the Suffolk Regiment. After training he proceeded to France, where he has done valuable service. He was only 24 years of age and was transferred to the Staffordshire Regiment two months before his death.

Preaching at the Town Baptist Church on Sunday evening, the Rev. Frank Batten said: "I cannot allow this occasion to pass without referring to the loss this church has received through the translation of our fellow-member Lance-Corporal J. Humphrey Stillman. He died of wounds received in action before his parents could reach his bedside last Monday at the hospital in France. He was trained in a Christian home, and that training was the foundation of his life. From his earliest years he took a deep interest in religious matters and as a school boy he was nick-named 'John-three-sixteen.' In public life and at the London University he was a brilliant scholar. Entering his profession, he became

Middlesex Chronicle 12/10/1918 pt1

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a member of the 'Institute of Bankers,' and manifested those intellectual gifts which marked him out for a great career. It is, however, as a humble Christian and a gifted church worker that we think of him to-day. He was baptised in this church by the Rev. Douglas Thompson on April 28th 1912, when he was 17 years of age, and was barely 24 when he died. He became leader in the junior Sunday School, secretary of the Christian Band, and Seat Steward in the church. It was fully anticipated that on his return he would fill important positions in this church. God has ordered it otherwise and has called him to the ranks of the church triumphant. Well might his parents be proud of such a son, and our loving sympathy is with them and theirs to-day. May they have the Saviour's Beatitude, 'Blessed are they that mourn for they shall be comforted.'"

SIGNALLER G. PLAYFORD.

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De Ruvigny's Roll of Honour, 1914-1919 (Ancestry)	
STILLMAN, JOHN HUMPHREY, L.-Corpl., No. 44682, 12th (Service) Battn. The Prince of Wales's (North Staffordshire Regt.), only s. of Frank Stillman, of 3, Tiverton Road, Hounslow, by his wife, Annie Ellen (—); <i>b.</i> St. Mary's, Paddington, W., 22 Oct. 1894; <i>educ.</i> Lower School of John Lyon, Harrow; was a Bank Clerk, and a member of the Bankers' Institute; joined the 6th (Cyclist) Suffolk Regt. 7 Oct. 1916; served with the Expeditionary Force in France and Flanders from June 1918, being transferred to the North Staffordshire Regt. the following June, and died at No. 8 Stationary Hospital, Wimereux, 30 Sept. following, of wounds received in action on the 12th of the same month. Buried in the British Cemetery, Turlenghem; <i>unm.</i>	De Ruvigny's Roll of Honour, 1914-1919 (Ancestry) STILLMAN, JOHN HUMPHREY, L.-Corpl., No. 44682, 12th (Service) Battn. The Prince of Wales's (North Staffordshire Regt.), only s. of Frank Stillman, of 3, Tiverton Road, Hounslow, by his wife, Annie Ellen (—); <i>b.</i> St. Mary's, Paddington, W., 22 Oct. 1894; <i>educ.</i> Lower School of John Lyon, Harrow; was a Bank Clerk, and a member of the Bankers' Institute; joined the 6th (Cyclist) Suffolk Regt. 7 Oct. 1916; served with the Expeditionary Force in France and Flanders from June 1918, being transferred to the North Staffordshire Regt. the following June, and died at No. 8 Stationary Hospital, Wimereux, 30 Sept. following, of wounds received in action on the 12th of the same month. Buried in the British Cemetery, Tatinghem; <i>unm.</i>

U of London Matriculation

* Ineligible for certificate or for registration as a Matriculated Student until completion of sixteenth year

LOWER SCHOOL OF JOHN LYON, HARROW. FORM VI

*650 Stillman, John Humphrey